Skills and Connectors

Teach AI once. Connect it to your apps.

Every concept in four easy pages, followed by one hard scenario MCQ that is split into its hidden parts and solved step by step.

PAGE 2
Understand
What a Skill and a Connector are, and the friction each one removes

PAGE 3
Choose and use
Four look-alike features, the decision test, built-in skills, connecting apps

PAGE 4
Build and fix
Build by talking, SKILL.md anatomy, descriptions, testing, troubleshooting

PAGE 5
Share and stay safe
Five places, two real risks, safe-use checklist, five projects

PAGES 6-8
Scenario MCQ
A hard question, its five parts, and how to analyse the answer

Made by
Taha Shabbir

Read it. Understand it. Answer it in the exam and the viva.

SCENARIO MCQ · Select TWO

MCQ: the missing flags

Read the story slowly. Some details are quiet clues. Do not turn the page yet.

Marlow & Pike Accountants is an 18-person firm. Senior accountant Hira Qureshi built a skill called *client-monthly-summary* in January using skill-creator. Its SKILL.md says: format amounts in the reporting currency, group items by expense head, **flag any payment above 250,000**, and use the four-section layout. Each month she types one sentence: "Prepare the client summary for Norvale Foods from their ledger in my Drive." The Drive connector is read-only and limited to the Ledgers folder. For eight months the summaries were right. In October, Norvale's auditor finds that three September payments of **180,000, 205,000 and 240,000** were never flagged. The firm lowered its reporting threshold to **150,000 on 1 September**, announced in a firm-wide email. Hira checks: the skill still fires from her normal sentence; currency, grouping and all four sections are correct; all 1,402 ledger rows were read. A brand-new chat gives the same result, and so does a colleague running the same skill from the organization directory.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Hira should do first?

A. The description is too vague, so the skill fires unreliably; she should add more trigger phrases to the description.

B. The chat has grown too long and the rules faded; she should start a fresh chat each month and restate the rules in two lines.

C. The connector cannot see every payment; she should widen Drive access to the whole drive so no ledger rows are missed.

D. Something around the skill changed: SKILL.md still says 250,000 while the firm now uses 150,000, so the file is out of date.

E. An exact check belongs in a small script; she should move the threshold check into a script and leave the wording as it is.

F. She should update the threshold in SKILL.md, then re-test with a payment exactly on the new threshold.

Pause here. Pick your TWO answers, then turn the page.

SCENARIO ANALYSIS · STEP 1

Split the story into 5 parts

Parts 1 to 4 set the scene and hide the clues. Part 5 picks the answer.

1 COMPANY

How to spot it: Who they are and what the person does. Usually the first sentence.

In this story: Marlow & Pike Accountants, 18 staff. Hira Qureshi is a senior accountant.

2 PROBLEM

How to spot it: The pressure: a deadline, a client, a failure to explain.

In this story: Norvale's auditor found three September payments that were never flagged.

3 ACTIONS

How to spot it: What the person already set up, asked or approved.

In this story: Built a skill with skill-creator. SKILL.md says flag above **250,000**. Read-only Drive connector scoped to Ledgers. One sentence each month.

4 WORKFLOW

How to spot it: What came back, and the state of the job now.

In this story: Eight good months, then a miss. Skill fires, format is right, all 1,402 rows read, a new chat and a colleague get the same result.

5 HIDDEN CLUE

How to spot it: One small detail that quietly decides the answer.

In this story: The file says 250,000, but the firm lowered the threshold to **150,000 on 1 September**. All three missed payments sit between the two numbers.

Eight quiet details planted in parts 1 to 4

1 SKILL.md still says 250,000 **2** The threshold fell to 150,000 on 1 September **3** The missed payments are 180,000, 205,000, 240,000: all between the two figures **4** Eight months of correct output **5** The skill still fires **6** Format, currency and sections are right **7** All 1,402 rows were read (so the connector is not the problem) **8** A new chat and a colleague on the shared skill get the same result (so it is not the chat; the fault is in the file).
Some details look like clues but only eliminate options. One detail decides.

The rule the hidden clue points to

From "When a skill misbehaves", note WHEN it went wrong:
- Wrong from the first reply: the file
- Worse as the chat grows: the chat
- Same mistake after tightening the wording: wrong place
- **It used to work and now does not: something around it changed**

Parts 1 to 4 set the scene. Part 5 picks the answer.

ANSWER KEY

MCQ: the missing flags

The two correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Hira should do first?

A. The description is too vague, so the skill fires unreliably; she should add more trigger phrases to the description.

B. The chat has grown too long and the rules faded; she should start a fresh chat each month and restate the rules in two lines.

C. The connector cannot see every payment; she should widen Drive access to the whole drive so no ledger rows are missed.

D. Something around the skill changed: SKILL.md still says 250,000 while the firm now uses 150,000, so the file is out of date. CORRECT

E. An exact check belongs in a small script; she should move the threshold check into a script and leave the wording as it is.

F. She should update the threshold in SKILL.md, then re-test with a payment exactly on the new threshold. CORRECT

Correct answers: D and F

PRACTICE MCQ 1 of 10

Practice 1

Greenfield Academy is a 40-teacher school. Coordinator Ayesha Rauf prepares a lesson plan for every class. Each Monday she types the same instructions to AI: **objective first, then activity, then homework**, and always keep the language simple for Grade 6. After that she opens the attendance sheet in Google Drive, copies the numbers for each class and pastes them into the chat. Last week she forgot to mention the homework section and the plans came back without it. She is tired of both chores, but she does not want AI to change anything in her Drive.

Which TWO statements are correct about what Ayesha needs?

A A Connector alone would remember the objective, activity and homework structure each Monday.

B A Skill with her lesson-plan structure fixes the re-explaining, because it teaches AI how to do it every time.

C A Skill alone would let AI open the attendance sheet in her Drive.

D Custom instructions are the right place for the lesson-plan structure, since they apply to every chat she ever has.

E A Drive Connector, started read-only, fixes the copy-pasting without letting AI change anything in her Drive.

F Neither is needed; a good prompt is enough for something she repeats every week.

PRACTICE MCQ 2 of 10

Practice 2

Pixel Lane is a six-person design agency. Social media lead Bilal Chaudhry built a skill called *brand-captions* with skill-creator. Its description says: **"Brand stuff for marketing."** When Bilal types "use my brand-captions skill", the captions come out perfect. When he types his normal sentence, "Write an Instagram caption for the new launch", AI returns generic captions with no brand voice at all. This has happened on every try since January, in new chats and for his colleague too. The rules inside SKILL.md are correct and complete.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Bilal should fix first?

- **A** The description tells AI nothing about what the skill does or when to use it, so it never matches his normal sentence.
- **B** The chat has grown too long, so he should start a fresh chat for every caption.
- **C** The same mistake survives tightened wording, so the caption rules belong in a small script.
- **D** He should rewrite the description to say what it does and use words he really types, such as Instagram, LinkedIn or X captions.
- **E** Skills only work when named, so he should always type the skill name and leave the description as it is.
- **F** An Instagram connector is missing, so he should connect it with read-and-write access.

PRACTICE MCQ 3 of 10

Practice 3

Crescent Books is a nine-person bookkeeping firm. Nadia Farooq built a skill called *month-end-report* whose description says: **"Handles accounting reports and calculations."** It produces a full seven-page month-end report, and the report is correct whenever she really wants one. But now the skill fires for everything: when Nadia asks "what is 15% of 48,000?", AI starts building a full month-end report. A new chat and a colleague on the shared skill show the same over-eager behaviour.

Which TWO statements are correct about how Nadia should fix this?

A She should add more trigger phrases so the skill covers even more kinds of calculations.

B She should turn off Code execution and file creation, because that setting makes skills fire too often.

C She should add a negative trigger, such as "Do NOT use for one-off calculations or quick questions; only for full month-end reports."

D She should switch the Drive connector to read-and-write so the skill has enough access to decide.

E She should start a fresh chat for every calculation, because a long chat makes the skill fire.

F She should ask AI "When would you use my skill?"; an answer wider or narrower than she meant shows what to fix.

PRACTICE MCQ 4 of 10

Practice 4

Summit Realty is a 15-agent property firm. Agent Imran Siddiqui uses a skill called *listing-writeup*. Every listing must show the price in PKR, four bullet highlights and a closing line with the agent's phone number. On Tuesday he wrote 30 listings in **one long chat**. The first eight were perfect; from about the 20th, the closing line disappeared and prices began appearing in dollars. On Wednesday he opened a new chat and the very first listing was perfect again. His colleague, using the same skill in a fresh chat, has no problems either. Nothing in the firm's rules has changed since January.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Imran should do first?

A. He should rewrite the description, because the skill has stopped matching his sentence.

B. The problem is the long chat, not the skill file, so he should not edit SKILL.md.

C. He should move the closing line into a script, because the same mistake survives tightened wording.

D. The skill has gone stale, so he should re-read SKILL.md against how the firm works today.

E. He should publish the skill to the organization directory so that it fixes itself.

F. He should start a fresh chat and restate the task in two lines.

PRACTICE MCQ 5 of 10

Practice 5

Lakeview Traders is a 22-person distributor. Accounts officer Farah Anwar built a skill called *invoice-check*. Its SKILL.md tells AI to add up all line items and flag any invoice whose total exceeds the approval limit. The skill fires correctly, the format is right, and the read-only Drive connector reads every invoice. But the total is sometimes off by a few rupees, and one invoice slipped under the limit. Farah has **tightened the wording three times** ("add carefully", "double-check every sum", "never round"). The same kind of mistake appears in every run, in new chats, and for her colleague.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Farah should do first?

A. The step is in the wrong place: an exact calculation such as a sum should not depend on wording alone.

B. She should tighten the wording a fourth time, in capital letters, with "never get this wrong".

C. The description is too vague, so she should add more trigger phrases.

D. The chat has grown too long, so she should start a fresh chat for every invoice.

E. She should ask skill-creator to move the totalling into a small script that the skill runs.

F. The connector cannot see every invoice, so she should widen Drive access to the whole drive.

PRACTICE MCQ 6 of 10

Practice 6

Northgate Consulting is a 14-person firm. Consultant Omar Javed writes a skill for client proposals. He saves the instructions in a file called *skill.md*, puts it in a folder named *Claude Proposal Writer*, and zips it for upload. In the frontmatter his name line reads **name: <proposal-writer-for-claude>**. The upload is rejected. Omar also worries that his 400-line instruction body will be read in every chat, even when he is only asking about the weather.

Which TWO statements are correct about the upload and about how skills load?

A A capitalised folder name that includes Claude is required so that AI knows where the skill works.

B The upload failed because a scripts folder is mandatory for every skill.

C The whole 400-line body is loaded into every chat, so he must cut it down to five lines.

D The file must be named exactly SKILL.md, in a kebab-case folder, with no angle brackets and no "claude" or "anthropic" in the name.

E Only the name and description are always loaded; the long instruction body loads only when the skill matches the task.

F Angle brackets around the name are required to mark it as a skill name.

PRACTICE MCQ 7 of 10

Practice 7

Harbor Freight Co. is a 12-person logistics firm. Operations lead Zain Abbas wants AI to clean up old shipment sheets. The firm's Drive holds shipment sheets, but also payroll, contracts and bank letters. Zain plans to connect the **entire Drive with read-and-write access** so that AI can "just fix everything". He has no backup and has never checked whether Drive keeps version history. He can open every folder himself.

Which TWO steps follow the safe-use checklist for connectors?

A Connect the whole Drive with write access; a connector cannot do anything harmful because it only reaches what he can open.

B Download a free cleanup skill from social media to do the deleting more safely.

C Start read-only and scope the connector to the smallest folder, such as the Shipments folder.

D Before allowing edits or deletes, check recovery, version history and undo, and keep backups.

E Turn on every connector in every chat so that AI can pick the safest one.

F Skip the backups; read-and-write is safe as long as he asks politely in the prompt.

PRACTICE MCQ 8 of 10

Practice 8

BrightWave Media is an 11-person agency. Marketer Sara Mirza sees a social-media post: "Free viral-captions skill, 10,000 downloads, just unzip and enable." A colleague has already installed it. The zip holds a SKILL.md and a scripts folder that Sara has not opened. Her account has a **Gmail connector with send access** and a Drive connector that reaches client contracts. She is about to enable the skill.

Which TWO statements are correct about what Sara should do?

A. She should read the skill first, or ask AI to explain it and flag anything that contacts external servers, handles credentials or could leak data.

B. A skill is only a text file, so it cannot make AI do anything harmful.

C. 10,000 downloads and a colleague's install prove that it is safe, so she can enable it now.

D. She should enable it first and review the output afterwards, since she can always undo a sent email.

E. She should upgrade the Gmail connector to full write access so that the skill works properly.

F. She should prefer built-in skills and the official directory over a random zip, because hidden instructions can cause prompt injection or data exfiltration.

PRACTICE MCQ 9 of 10

Practice 9

Ledger & Co is a 20-person software and design studio. Developers use a code-based tool, designers use Cowork, and director Danish Rehman uses claude.ai on his phone. Danish wants one shared way of working for all three groups. The studio also keeps several **custom GPTs and Gemini Gems** that hold its best instructions. Danish wonders whether to write the same instructions as skills or to keep them inside the GPTs and Gems.

Which TWO statements are correct about portability?

A A custom GPT can be dropped into a skills folder and will run unchanged in any tool.

B Skills are an open standard, also read by tools such as Codex CLI, Gemini CLI, VS Code and Cursor, so one skill can run across the studio's tools.

C A skill written in claude.ai must be rewritten in code before a code-based tool can read it.

D Custom GPTs and Gems are not portable: each lives only inside its own product.

E Cowork cannot reach files on the computer, only apps from the directory.

F Code-based tools cannot be connected to apps at all, so connectors work only in claude.ai.

PRACTICE MCQ 10 of 10

Practice 10

Atlas Freelance Hub is a five-person team. Hassan Raza lists four things he wants from AI. **One:** today only, work out the tax on one odd invoice. **Two:** every chat, always, should be short and direct. **Three:** every Friday, pull last week's tickets from Linear and write the status report in the team's fixed format. **Four:** keep one client's files and rules loaded for every chat inside that client's area.

Which TWO matches between wish and feature are correct?

A. Wish one (the one-off tax question) deserves a Skill so that it becomes reusable.

B. Wish four (one client's files and rules) is best handled by a Connector.

C. Wish two (short and direct in every chat) belongs in custom instructions.

D. Wish two should be a Skill, since a skill is the right place for a preference that applies to every chat.

E. Wish three needs both: a Connector to fetch the Linear tickets and a Skill to shape the report.

F. Wish three needs only a Skill, because a skill can fetch the tickets from Linear by itself.

ANSWER 1 of 10

Answer 1

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct about what Ayesha needs?

A. A Connector alone would remember the objective, activity and homework structure each Monday.

B. A Skill with her lesson-plan structure fixes the re-explaining, because it teaches AI how to do it every time. CORRECT

C. A Skill alone would let AI open the attendance sheet in her Drive.

D. Custom instructions are the right place for the lesson-plan structure, since they apply to every chat she ever has.

E. A Drive Connector, started read-only, fixes the copy-pasting without letting AI change anything in her Drive. CORRECT

F. Neither is needed; a good prompt is enough for something she repeats every week.

Why: Re-explaining how = Skill friction. Copy-pasting from another app = Connector friction. A Connector is access, a Skill is expertise, and connectors start read-only. Custom instructions apply to all chats, which a lesson-plan format should not.

Correct answers: B and E

ANSWER 2 of 10

Answer 2

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Bilal should fix first?

A **The description tells AI nothing about what the skill does or when to use it, so it never matches his normal sentence.** CORRECT

B The chat has grown too long, so he should start a fresh chat for every caption.

C The same mistake survives tightened wording, so the caption rules belong in a small script.

D **He should rewrite the description to say what it does and use words he really types, such as Instagram, LinkedIn or X captions.** CORRECT

E Skills only work when named, so he should always type the skill name and leave the description as it is.

F An Instagram connector is missing, so he should connect it with read-and-write access.

Why: Wrong from the first reply = the file. The description is the only thing AI reads to decide if a skill fires, so it needs what the skill does plus the trigger words a user would really say.

Correct answers: A and D

ANSWER 3 of 10

Answer 3

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct about how Nadia should fix this?

A. She should add more trigger phrases so the skill covers even more kinds of calculations.

B. She should turn off Code execution and file creation, because that setting makes skills fire too often.

C. She should add a negative trigger, such as "Do NOT use for one-off calculations or quick questions; only for full month-end reports." CORRECT

D. She should switch the Drive connector to read-and-write so the skill has enough access to decide.

E. She should start a fresh chat for every calculation, because a long chat makes the skill fire.

F. She should ask AI "When would you use my skill?"; an answer wider or narrower than she meant shows what to fix. CORRECT

Why: A broad description fires too eagerly. A negative trigger narrows it, and asking AI when it would use the skill is the simple test that shows whether the description is narrower or wider than intended.

Correct answers: C and F

ANSWER 4 of 10

Answer 4

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Imran should do first?

A. He should rewrite the description, because the skill has stopped matching his sentence.

B. The problem is the long chat, not the skill file, so he should not edit SKILL.md. CORRECT

C. He should move the closing line into a script, because the same mistake survives tightened wording.

D. The skill has gone stale, so he should re-read SKILL.md against how the firm works today.

E. He should publish the skill to the organization directory so that it fixes itself.

F. He should start a fresh chat and restate the task in two lines. CORRECT

Why: Right at first, worse as the chat grows = the chat, not the skill. Do not edit the file; start a fresh chat and restate the task in two lines. A new chat that works again rules out the file.

Correct answers: B and F

ANSWER 5 of 10

Answer 5

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct: what the evidence points to, and what Farah should do first?

- **A** **The step is in the wrong place: an exact calculation such as a sum should not depend on wording alone.** — CORRECT
- **B** She should tighten the wording a fourth time, in capital letters, with "never get this wrong".
- **C** The description is too vague, so she should add more trigger phrases.
- **D** The chat has grown too long, so she should start a fresh chat for every invoice.
- **E** **She should ask skill-creator to move the totalling into a small script that the skill runs.** — CORRECT
- **F** The connector cannot see every invoice, so she should widen Drive access to the whole drive.

Why: Same mistake every run, even after tightening the wording = the step is in the wrong place. An exact step (a sum, a threshold check) belongs in a small script. Data the skill guesses should come in through a connector.

Correct answers: A and E

ANSWER 6 of 10

Answer 6

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct about the upload and about how skills load?

A. A capitalised folder name that includes Claude is required so that AI knows where the skill works.

B. The upload failed because a scripts folder is mandatory for every skill.

C. The whole 400-line body is loaded into every chat, so he must cut it down to five lines.

D. The file must be named exactly SKILL.md, in a kebab-case folder, with no angle brackets and no "claude" or "anthropic" in the name. CORRECT

E. Only the name and description are always loaded; the long instruction body loads only when the skill matches the task. CORRECT

F. Angle brackets around the name are required to mark it as a skill name.

Why: Upload rules: a file named exactly SKILL.md, a kebab-case folder name, no angle brackets, no "claude" or "anthropic" in the name. Level 1 (name and description) is always loaded; level 2 (the instructions) loads when matched.

Correct answers: D and E

ANSWER 7 of 10

Answer 7

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO steps follow the safe-use checklist for connectors?

A. Connect the whole Drive with write access; a connector cannot do anything harmful because it only reaches what he can open.

B. Download a free cleanup skill from social media to do the deleting more safely.

C. Start read-only and scope the connector to the smallest folder, such as the Shipments folder. CORRECT

D. Before allowing edits or deletes, check recovery, version history and undo, and keep backups. CORRECT

E. Turn on every connector in every chat so that AI can pick the safest one.

F. Skip the backups; read-and-write is safe as long as he asks politely in the prompt.

Why: Start connectors read-only and scope them to the smallest folder or app. Before edits or deletes, check recovery, version history and undo, and keep backups. Inheriting your permissions does not make a wrong delete harmless.

Correct answers: C and D

ANSWER 8 of 10

Answer 8

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct about what Sara should do?

A **She should read the skill first, or ask AI to explain it and flag anything that contacts external servers, handles credentials or could leak data.** CORRECT

B A skill is only a text file, so it cannot make AI do anything harmful.

C 10,000 downloads and a colleague's install prove that it is safe, so she can enable it now.

D She should enable it first and review the output afterwards, since she can always undo a sent email.

E She should upgrade the Gmail connector to full write access so that the skill works properly.

F **She should prefer built-in skills and the official directory over a random zip, because hidden instructions can cause prompt injection or data exfiltration.** CORRECT

Why: A skill is a text file AI will follow, so hidden instructions can manipulate it (prompt injection) or send information out (data exfiltration). Install from trusted sources and read a skill before enabling it.

Correct answers: A and F

ANSWER 9 of 10

Answer 9

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO statements are correct about portability?

A. A custom GPT can be dropped into a skills folder and will run unchanged in any tool.

B. **Skills are an open standard, also read by tools such as Codex CLI, Gemini CLI, VS Code and Cursor, so one skill can run across the studio's tools.** CORRECT

C. A skill written in claude.ai must be rewritten in code before a code-based tool can read it.

D. **Custom GPTs and Gems are not portable: each lives only inside its own product.** CORRECT

E. Cowork cannot reach files on the computer, only apps from the directory.

F. Code-based tools cannot be connected to apps at all, so connectors work only in claude.ai.

Why: Skills have been an open standard since December 2025: write once, run across tools. Custom GPTs and Gems are handy but each lives only inside its own product. Code-based tools set connectors up once in a config file.

Correct answers: B and D

ANSWER 10 of 10

Answer 10

Correct answers are highlighted in green.

Which TWO matches between wish and feature are correct?

A Wish one (the one-off tax question) deserves a Skill so that it becomes reusable.

B Wish four (one client's files and rules) is best handled by a Connector.

C Wish two (short and direct in every chat) belongs in custom instructions. CORRECT

D Wish two should be a Skill, since a skill is the right place for a preference that applies to every chat.

E Wish three needs both: a Connector to fetch the Linear tickets and a Skill to shape the report. CORRECT

F Wish three needs only a Skill, because a skill can fetch the tickets from Linear by itself.

Why: Custom instructions are for what is true everywhere, always. For real data that must come out your way you need both: the Connector fetches, the Skill shapes. A one-off answer is just a good prompt, and a client area with fixed files and rules is a Project.

Correct answers: C and E